

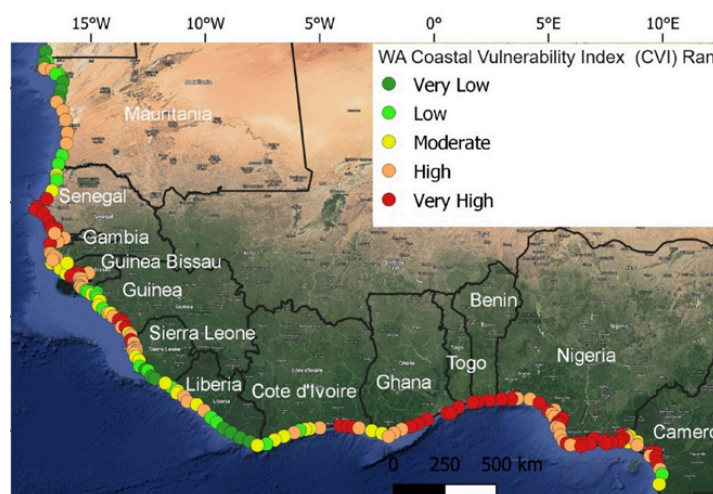
EROSION IS CRUMBLING AFRICA'S COAST!

11th May, 2026

Coastal Erosion

Coastal erosion is a current reality for West African nations. About [80% of the West African coast is categorized as moderate-to-very high vulnerability](#), with the coastline receding as much as [10 to 30 meters per year](#) in "hotspots".

While sea level rise is a factor, human activity is the primary culprit. Sand mining, poorly planned coastal infrastructure, mangrove destruction, and rapid urban expansion drive coastal erosion. This transcends mere sand loss to disrupt the region's economic engine. Damage to landing beaches, fish processing areas, and mangrove ecosystems reduces fish productivity and household income, especially for women engaged in fish processing and marketing.



West African overall coastal vulnerability index (CVI), 2024. Retrieved from <https://doi.org/10.1038/s41598-023-48612-5>

Women as Catalysts for Coastal Resilience and Community Action

Addressing coastal erosion requires strong planning, science-based management, regional cooperation, ecosystem restoration, and inclusive participation. Women in aquatic science and management are uniquely positioned to serve as vital catalysts for resilience by leveraging our expertise to bridge the gap between high-level policy and community-level action. This includes:

- Leading citizen science initiatives to monitor shoreline changes
- Conducting advocacy that ensures women's unique economic needs are integrated into national management plans
- Spearheading nature-based restoration projects and
- Translating complex climate data into actionable insights for local cooperatives